More Consequences

Consequences

Structure of the Judgment Dialogue

- God questions the man
- The man diverts attention to the woman
  - "*The woman you gave me,* ***she*** *. . .*"
- God questions the woman
- The woman diverts attention to the serpent
- God addresses the serpent
- God pronounces punishment on the serpent

Did the diversions work??

Did they play God for the fool??

Consequences

Structure of the Judgment Dialogue

- God questions the man
- The man diverts attention to the woman
  - "*The woman you gave me,* ***she*** *. . .*"
- God questions the woman
- The woman diverts attention to the serpent
- God addresses the serpent
- God pronounces punishment on the serpent
- God pronounces judgment on the serpent
- God turns back to the woman and pronounces judgment
- God turns back to the man and pronounces judgment

Consequences

Did the diversions work??

Did they play God for the fool??

- No! But why this presentation?
  - Heightens tension

    ("Are they getting away with the 'blame game'?")
  - Demonstrates that the focus of the overall dialogue is the conversation with ***the man***.

Consequences

Focus on the Man

- The presentation
  - Diversion away and return implies the focus is on the man
- The content
  - *And they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in the garden in the cool of the day. And **he hid**, the man and his wife.*
  - "*And the Lord God called **to the man**. And he said **to him**, 'Where are **you** (singular)?'"*
  - Space devoted to each character
    - 88 words for the man
    - 38 for the serpent
    - 28 for the woman
  - Both the setup *(chapter 2)* and the judgment focus on the man and God

And the Lord God called to the man.
And he said to him:
"Where are you?"
And he said:
"Your voice I heard in the garden,
and I saw that I was naked, and I hid."
And he said:
"Who told you that you are naked?
The tree that I commanded you to not eat of it,
did you eat from it?"
And the man said:
"The woman that you gave to be with me,
***she**, she gave to me from the tree. And I ate."*
And the Lord God said to the woman:
"What is this you did?"
And the woman said:
"The serpent deceived me. And I ate."

Observations

"the knowledge of good and bad"

- Humans are making *independent* assessments
- Both tell the truth
  - "the woman gave me to eat"
  - "the serpent deceived me"
- But both "spin" the story for their own interests
  - it's the woman's fault
  - you gave her to me
  - the serpent deceived me
- Typical Behavior
  - protect self
  - blame others, even God

Consequences

And the Lord God said to the serpent:

"Because you have done this,
cursed are you above all cattle
and above all the beasts of the field.

Upon your belly you will go,
and dirt you will eat all the days of your life.

"And enmity I will set between you and between the woman,
and between your seed and between her seed.

He will bruise your head,
but you, you will bruise his heel."

Consequences

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but you, you will bruise his heel."

Consequences

The Serpent

- Again, an animal or Satan?
  - Animal
    - fits the story: “a beast of the field”
    - snakes crawl on their bellies
    - there is hostility between snakes and humans
    - humans “crush” snakes’ heads
  - Satan
    - evil present in creation prior to the Fall *(Romans 12)*
    - snakes don’t bruise humans’ heels
    - the curse concerns the ***serpent*** himself, not his seed

Consequences

The Serpent

- Resolution?
  - Pay attention to who is speaking
    - God speaks, and often says more than is obvious to the original audience
  - References to "seed"
    - "seed" refers to future generations, not the current characters
    - ***But***, it is the ***serpent's*** head that is crushed, not his seed's

      *"He (the woman's seed) will bruise **your** head,"*
    - and, the heel of the woman's seed is bruised by the ***serpent himself***

      *"but **you**, you will bruise his heel."*
  - This prophecy is *a double entendre*
    - applies to humans and snakes
    - prophesies the conflict between Jesus and Satan

Consequences

The Woman

- Difficult to understand
- Hermeneutical Method:
  - The answer must meet three criteria
    1. must accurately reflect the text
    2. must be repeated throughout Scripture
    3. must be true in real life

Consequences

The Woman

To the woman he said:

"I will greatly increase your toilsome labor and pregnancy.

In hard labor you will bear sons,

And to your husband your desire.

But as for him, he will rule over you."

Consequences

The Woman

To the woman he said:

"I will greatly increase your toilsome labor and pregnancy.
In hard labor you will bear sons,

And to your husband your desire.
But as for him, he will rule over you."

Consequences

The Woman

- Hard labor in bearing children
  1. meaning of the text is clear
  2. and the reality of it is repeated throughout Scripture
     Isa. 13:8; 21:3; Jer. 6:24; 22:23; 50:43; Ps. 48:6; etc.
  1. clearly true in real life

Consequences

The Woman

To the woman he said:

"I will greatly increase your toilsome labor and pregnancy.

In hard labor you will bear sons,

And to your husband your desire.

But as for him, he will rule over you."

Consequences

The Woman

"to your husband your desire"

- Common Options
  - the woman will try to dominate her husband
    - Justification: Sin lying at Cain's door
      - *"to your man your desire, but he, he will rule over you"*
      - *"to you its desire and you will rule over it"*
    - Problem: the idea is not repeated throughout Scripture
  - Desire to have children
    - Justification:
      1. reflects the text
      2. Repeated throughout Scripture
         Sarah, Rachel, Leah, Hannah, etc.
      1. True in real life

Consequences

The Woman

To the woman he said:

"I will greatly increase your toilsome labor and pregnancy.

In hard labor you will bear sons.

And to your husband your desire.

***But** as for him, he will rule over you."*

Consequences

The Woman

"he will rule over you"

- Common Options
  - ensure submission
  - control
  - authority

Consequences

The Woman

"he will rule over you"

- Hebrew "to rule": *mashal*
  - associated with authority and service
  - suggested translation: to govern
- Presents as a contrast to the woman's desire (*"but"*)
  - foreshadows conflict
  - male domination follows in Scripture and reality
    - e.g., Genesis 6
  - This is a "post-Fall" situation
  - See Eph 5:22-33 for proper "post-Fall relationship"

Consequences

The Man

But to the man he said:

"Because . . .

you have paid attention to the voice of your wife,

and you ate from the tree that I commanded you

saying, You will not eat from it,'

cursed is the ground because of you.

In toilsome labor you will eat from it all the days of your life.

And thorns and thistles it will produce for you.

And you will eat the herbs of the field.

In the sweat of your face you will eat bread

until your return to the ground,

for from it you were taken.

From dirt you are, and to dirt you will return."

Consequences

The Man

- The wording focuses on . . .
  - who the man listened to
  - food
  - the ground

Consequences

The Man

But to the man he said:

"Because . . .

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and you ate from the tree that I commanded you

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And thorns and thistles it will produce for you.

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until your return to the ground,

for from it you were taken.

From dirt you are, and to dirt you will return."

Consequences

The Man

Listening to his wife

- The issue is listening to his wife in contrast to listening to God

Because . . .

you have paid attention to the voice of your wife,
and you ate from the tree that I commanded you
saying, You will not eat from it,'

Consequences

The Man

Food

- Why the focus on food?
  - He will now have to work for his own food
  - This food is different and does not end in life
- New Testament Illustration
  - John 4:31-38
    - Jesus' food is to do the will of his father
    - Disciples
      - called to reap the fields
      - reward is the fruit of the field
      - they reap what they haven't sown
      - the food is to eternal life

Consequences

The Man

The Ground

- Ruined relationship of the man and ground
  - Genesis 1: the ground to produce food for man
  - Genesis 2: Man created from the ground
  - Genesis 3:
    - The ground cursed because of the man
    - Man must now serve the ground instead of the garden
    - Man's service of the ground is hard labor vs. rest
    - Man must now eat from the ground instead of the garden
    - Man will return to the ground

Consequences

The Man

Focal Topics

- Two environments
  - Utopia of the garden
  - Curse of the ground
- Two types of service
  - Serving God (rest)
  - Serving self (hard labor)
- Two types of food
  - Food provided by God *(Ezek 47:1-14)*
  - Food from the cursed ground *(thorns & thistles)*

Emphasis of God's Speech

- God's emphasis is on ***actions*** rather than motives
  - God to the man: "*Have you eaten?*"
  - God to the woman, "*What have you done?*"
  - God to the serpent, "*Because you have done this*"
  - God to the man, "*Because you have . . . eaten*"
- Thus, the focus is not just on the man . . .

  it is also on his ***actions***.

Characterization of the Man's Actions

- Presented in terms of the interaction between the serpent and the woman
  - Conduct of subordinate characters do not usually determine a story's outcome, except in its impact on the primary character.
  - But the woman-serpent interaction doesn't impact the man.
- Although there is no presentation of effect on the man, the narrator states, "*and he ate*."
- Thus, the issue is his ***reaction*** to the woman-serpent interchange, namely, his choice to acquiesce.

Characterization of the Man's Actions

In a story which is essentially about ***him***

the man allows his fortune and that of the earth to be reversed

through the interaction between one over whom he has dominion and his suitable helper.

Therefore, his sin is characterized as . . .

PASSIVITY

The ***one responsible to lead*** doesn't do so.

He's just as a passive participant.

Basis of God's Judgment

- The reason for the ***serpent's*** judgment is vague ("*because you have done this*").
- No basis is given for the ***woman's*** judgment.
- But the basis for the ***man's*** judgment is clear. . .

  eating as a result of obeying his wife instead of God.
- Thus . . .
  - The man is the primary character.
  - His sin is the focal point of the narrative.
  - That sin is passivity, obeying his wife instead of God.
  - But, the emphasis is not disobedience as much as the failure to fulfill his intended role in creation

Content of God's Judgment

- Judgment on the ***serpent*** relates to interaction between his and the woman's seeds.
- Judgment on the ***woman*** relates to interaction with the man, and increased pain.
- Judgment on the ***man*** affects ***creation*,**

- The curse negatively affects ***the purpose of humanity*.**
  - Disharmony between humanity and animals *(rule over animals)*
  - Disharmony between humanity and creation *(subdue the earth)*
  - Disharmony between male and female *(be fruitful & multiply)*

And the man called the name of his wife Havah, because she, she was the mother of all living.

- Hebrew: “life”
- Why name her ***after*** the judgement??
  - Hope for continued life in children

*And the man called the name of his wife Havah, because **she**, she was the mother of all living.*

- Hebrew: "life"
- Why name her after the judgement??
  - Hope for continued life in children
- Emphasis on the woman as the producer of life
  - Probably derives from "her" seed (3:15)
- Note:
  - This is the ***man's*** perspective
  - He is looking for continued life
  - This is the first of many presentations of hope for future life

And the Lord God made for the man and for his wife tunics of skin,
And he clothed them.

- Weren't they already clothed?
- No!
  - They made aprons of fig leaves
  - God made tunics of skin

And the Lord God made for the man and for his wife tunics of skin,
And he ***clothed*** *them.*

- Weren't they already clothed?
- No!
  - They made aprons of fig leaves
  - God made tunics of skin
  - Only with the tunics are they said to actually be clothed.
- God's provision met the need.

God's Provision of Clothing

- Not for God's benefit
  - God created humanity naked
  - Clothing was the human's idea
  - Their attempt didn't work for them *(they hid, tho "clothed")*
  - Scripture:
    - Hypocrites (tombstone vs dead bones, *Matt 23:27*)
    - Man looks on the outward appearance, but God on the heart *(1 Sam 16:7*)
    - All things are naked and open to God *(Heb 4:13)*
- Rather, to cover the human's shame

Because you say, "I am rich, and I have become rich and have need of nothing, but don't realize that you are wretched, and pitiable, and poor, and blind, and naked," I counsel you to buy from me gold purified by fire, that you can become rich, and white clothing, that the shame of your nakedness not be exposed, and eye salve to put on your eyes so you can see.

Rev 3:17–18

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Rev 3:17–18

Clothing of Skins

- Symbolism
  - Animals are a foil for humanity apart from God
  - Humans apart from God are condemned to death
  - Animals die to cover humanity's shame
    - introduction of substitutionary death

And the Lord God said:

"Behold, the man has become like one of us
to know good and bad.
And now . . . lest he send out his hand
and take even from the tree of life,
and eat,
and live forever . . ."

And the Lord God sent him from the garden eastward,
to serve the ground
from which he was taken.
And he banished the man.
And he made dwell east of the garden of Eden cherubim
and a flaming whirling sword to keep the way of the tree
of life.

And the Lord God said:

"Behold, the man has become like one of us
to know good and bad.
And now . . . lest he send out his hand
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Tree of Life

- Highly symbolic
  - The source of "what is really" life
    - what is really life *(1 Tim 6:19)*
    - abundant life *(John 10:10)*
    - Proverbs, multiple times referring to non-material life
    - as entrance into paradise *(Rev 2:7; 22:2, 14, 19)*
  - Banishment
    - prohibited from experience real life
    - condemned to return to the ground

A New Normal

- Need to take care of self
- Hard labor instead of rest
- Poor results from labor
- Alienation between humans
- Separation from continued life
- A degree of alienation from God
- Destined to return to dirt

Themes

Primary Theme

- Develops matters introduced in Day 6.
- The man fails to fulfill his divinely appointed role in creation.
- Man's failure negatively impacts matters of Day 6.
  - Relationship with the earth
  - Relationship with animals
  - Relationship with his helper *(destroying the "image of God")*

Tension

- Creation account presents a tension
  - Focuses on progressive vitality
  - Rhetorically foreshadows problems (day-night cycle, “subdue”)
  - But Day 7 presents perfection
- Eden narrative explains and develops that tension . . .
  - Reveals human failure to subdue & rule
  - Reveals the impact of human failure on God’s creation
- While creating its its own tension
  - Death results, but . . .
  - Hope for life still exists as, in view of 3:15, Adam names the woman “mother of all living” ***following the sentence of death***

More Tension

<u>The Creation Account</u>

the vitality of creation existing under a shadow

<u>The Eden Narrative</u>

a devastated creation

with hope for future life